management, we ushered in a new era in ICICI. In 1959, the Indian economy received a new impetus…ICICI's business was rising every year. At the same time, ICICI's staff strength increased fourfold. Along with this able and efficient staff, the entire group was well tuned like a perfect symphony.'[4]

Mehta also brought to the organization a degree of informality which it lacked in the earlier days. He believed in delegating jobs, and certainly believed in not doing things for which he had no capacity. Under him relationships among the staff became easy and relaxed. His direct association with ICICI began when he was fifty-eight. However, he brought to the task the zeal and drive of a much younger man. He took his duties seriously, and was fully conversant with what was happening in the organization. More importantly, he brought to his job an élan, a sense of mission. With him ICICI came out of its shell, became an outward looking organization.

Aparna Basu recalls in her biography of G.L. Mehta, her father, that Parekh or Hasmukhbhai as they called him, and his wife Hirabehn, had become like members of their family. 'Hasmukhbhai was a gentle, reticent and modest person but extremely knowledgeable about the stock market, investments, etc. He was also a man of impeccable integrity. Bapu took him into confidence on all matters and trusted him fully and regarded him like a younger brother. Hasmukhbhai had great regard and respect towards Bapu. On his deathbed, a few hours before he passed away, Bapu asked for Parekh as he called him.'[5]

Apart from Mehta, Parekh struck up an enduring relationship with William Diamond. Black had the good sense to depute Diamond only in an advisory role. This, however, did not prevent the weekly tabloid *Blitz* from reporting (incorrectly) that an American called William Diamond had been appointed as the Managing Director of ICICI. ICICI's role was to 'take Mr Diamond fully into the bosom of the family and give him every opportunity to participate fully in the affairs of the company.' Black's hope that Diamond be taken into ICIC's bosom was fully realized and apart from participating in all policy decisions and conducting seminars for the staff, Diamond was also the moving spirit behind ICICI's first brochure to the business community in which ICICI's role was fully explained.